



HTC's new camera

In an infographic about the history of photography, the company hinted at a new experience with smartphone cameras in 2013

Archos releases free app

Archos released a free version of its video player app for Android devices which has most of the features of the paid app

Macbook refresh, Intel TV and more

We take a look at news stories that made a buzz in month that went by

At the time of writing, we were waiting with baited breath for Sony's big reveal on February 20th, considered to be the next-generation PlayStation console. Unfortunately, considering the short month, and our regular effort to get the issue to stand in time for our readers, we've decided not to include it in our roundup of the month's buzz. You can check out thinkdigit.com for the latest details about it anyway (<http://digit.in/11QG4Dt>). In the meanwhile, take a tour of the month's biggest happenings

Next-gen Xbox to feature 500GB storage, mandatory Kinect

As the date for E3 edges closer and closer, we're getting little spurts of leaks about the upcoming updated Xbox console (aka Xbox 720), codenamed Durango. The source of the leak, who goes by the alias SuperDaE, who seems to be in possession of a number of white papers on the next-gen console from Microsoft, papers essentially written for game developers. Included in these documents are some very interesting details that, as we have learnt from the past, are not all necessarily the guidelines for the final production model.

Amongst the many new features, the first that sticks out is the new "always-on" Kinect setup. The next-gen console might require the Kinect unit to be plugged in, switched on and configured to the room in

order for the Xbox to work. The Kinect unit itself has apparently received a major design overhaul, with the camera now allegedly sporting a resolution of 1920x1080 and being capable of capturing information in colour. According to SuperDaE, the new Kinect will be capable of independently tracking your thumbs, determining whether your hand is open or closed, and even, it's claimed, reading your facial expression and seeing whether you're angry, sad or excited. The improved viewing angle is so wide that the new Kinect doesn't



Next Gen Xbox 2

even need to nod to find the best viewing angle. We do hope that it has reduced the minimum distance players need to stand, so those with smaller living rooms can once again find their Kinect units useful.

The second interesting feature in the leak is that 500GB storage built-in, with no "non-500GB option." The reason for this seems to be that every game disc will require you to install it, as the console will be incapable of reading any game data directly from the disk. This could be Microsoft's way of ensuring that a disk is not used across various consoles, as a means to stop second hand game trading. But SuperDaE has shared that the game instal-

lation feature is actually pretty neat as it auto-installs the game in the background, in chunks. This could help reduce initial game load times, and definitely will do away with the annoying loading screens.

Apple refreshes Retina Macbook Pro and 13-inch Air lineup, slashes prices

In what is essentially a surprise announcement from Apple, the company has slashed the prices of the Retina MacBook Pro range, along with the 13-inch MacBook Air (with the 256GB SSD). The Retina MacBook Pro will also get a processor line-up refresh.

Let us start with the MacBook Pro first. The 13-inch MacBook Pro with Retina Display now starts at ₹99,900 (formerly ₹1,14,900). This has an Intel Core i5 processor, 8GB of RAM and 128GB SSD. The slightly upgraded version of the 13-inch MacBook Pro with Retina will now cost ₹1,14,900, with a new 2.6 GHz processor which replaces the 2.5GHz processor, 8GB of RAM and 256GB flash storage.

The entry level 15-inch MacBook Pro with Retina Display now gets the faster Intel Core i7 2.4GHz quad-core processor with the 8GB of RAM remaining

the same, while the top-of-the-line version gets the new Intel Core i7 2.7GHz quad-core processor and 16GB of RAM. The 15-inch Retina MacBook Pro with the 2.4GHz quad-core Intel Core i7 processor is priced at ₹1,52,900, while the version with the 2.7GHz quad-core Intel Core i7 is priced at ₹1,92,900.

The top of the line MacBook Air 13 with a 1.8GHz processor, 4GB of RAM and 256GB storage gets a price cut of ₹5,000, and is now available for ₹94,900 (formerly ₹99,900). Prices of the MacBook Air 13 128GB SSD version and the MacBook Air 11's 64GB and 128GB SSD versions remain the same.

Google Glass to include bone conduction technology

Google's ambitious and futuristic, augmented reality project – Google Glass which has a pair of glasses with a Heads Up Display (HUD) is seeing some new developments. As per reports about Google's recent submission of their FCC filings for the device, it has been revealed that the pair of glasses will include bone conduction technology.

This technology will enable its users to listen to audio without using any kind of earbuds or earphones. Vibra-



13-inch MacBook Pro